READINGS · DAY 2

Data management II

Combining files, reshaping and presenting. Short, targeted reading: the parts that match today, not whole books.

R03 Mitchell, M. N. (2020). *Data Management Using Stata: A Practical Handbook*, 2nd ed. College Station, TX: Stata Press.
Read: The chapters on combining datasets (`append`, `merge`), on reshaping, and on collapsing.
Why today: Day 2 in book form, with the merge pitfalls (unmatched records, `m:1` versus `1:1`) worked through on small files.
Copyrighted book: cited only.

R01 Bjärkefur, K., Cardoso de Andrade, L., Daniels, B. and Jones, M. R. (2021). *Development Research in Practice: The DIME Analytics Data Handbook*. Washington, DC: World Bank.
Read: Chapter 5 (cleaning and processing research data).
Why today: Why each dataset needs a unique, documented identifier before it is merged, and how to check it with `isid`.
`https://openknowledge.worldbank.org/handle/10986/35594`
Open access, CC BY 3.0 IGO: free to download and share with attribution.

R13 StataCorp. *Stata Reference Manuals* (installed with Stata): [U] User's Guide, [D] Data Management, [G] Graphics, [SVY] Survey Data, [R] Base Reference, [TS] Time Series, [XT] Longitudinal Data/Panel Data, [P] Programming, [RPT] Reporting.
Read: [D] `merge`, `append`, `reshape`, `collapse`; [G] `graph bar`, `twoway`.
Why today: Every option of the commands behind today's tables and charts.
Installed with Stata. Open them from Stata: `help` *command*, then the PDF link at the top of the help page. Not copied into this package.

Codes R01–R13 are the same on every day's list and in the workbook bibliography. Links checked October 2026. Copyrighted books and the Stata manuals are cited, not copied; the open-licence documents named *in this folder* are shared under their stated licence.